Wizard Jumble

GDD (Game Design Document)

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The Basics

Title & Tagline: Wizard Jumble – Who is first to brew the potion?
Quick Pitch: 1-4 wizards are seeking the ingredients for the same potion. The ingredients are spread across the playing board and must be collected in the right order. The wizards must decide in every round their next 4 moves, thinking forward and hoping not to be pushed during the subrounds.

Singleplayer: Collect the ingredients for your potion in the right order and bring them back to your cauldron without game over.

Multiplayer: The first player to collect all ingredients in the right order and bring them back to their cauldron wins. Game over means starting over at your cauldron with no ingredients.



How It Plays (Gameplay & Mechanics):

The Core Loop:
For each round every player receives 8 playing cards and must put 4 of them down in the order they wish to use them. These 4 cards are then locked, and the wizard will move according to these over 4 subrounds.
The player must locate the next ingredient they need to collect and use the cards to move towards it while dodging and using the elements on the board.

Key Actions:
Players move according to the cards laid down in the beginning of the round.
All possible cards:

- Move 1

- Move 2
- Move 3
- Turn left
- Turn right
- U-turn

Each card has a value between 1-100. For each subround the card with the highest value will start, the second highest then moves and so on. If two cards have the same value it is decided randomly who moves first.

Game Rules & Systems:
Each player has 3 life tokens and room for 7 damage tokens. If a player receives 7 damage tokens the 7 damage tokens are removed and they lose 1 life token. A life token can also be lost if the player falls off the board or into fog.
At the loss of a life token the player re-spawns where they last picked an ingredient. If no ingredient has been picked, they spawn at their cauldron. If a player loses all 3 life tokens, they lose all ingredients collected and spawn at their cauldron.

The game is played on a board divided into equal squares. Each square can only hold one wizard, this means that if one wizard moves onto a square where another wizard already stands, the wizard moving pushes the other onto the next square in the direction they are moving. If a wall is placed in the direction, they are pushed, the wizard cannot be pushed, and nobody moves.

Board elements and their rules vary with the board design but for the standard board it is:

- **Stream**: If a wizard stands on a stream square the wizard will move 1 square with the stream. Without changing their direction.
- **Turning flowers**: If a wizard stands on a turning flower the wizard will turn in the direction the flower indicates. (will be indicated with arrow)
- **Carnivorous plants:** At the end of a subround the carnivorous plants will snap at everyone who is placed in the 8 surrounding squares. This will inflict 1 damage token.
- **Spider web:** Should a wizard move into a spider web they are haltered and will be stuck for the remaining of that subround. In the beginning of a new subround the wizard is free to move away from the spider web. You can use turn cards when standing on a spider web square.
- **Bezoar:** If a wizard stands on a square with a bezoar the bezoar will heal one damage token.
- **Fog:** If a wizard passes a square with fog at any time the wizard will fall through the fog, lose one life token and re-spawn accordingly

At the end of each subround the following protocol is followed:

1. The water runs
2. Turning flowers turn
3. Carnivorous plants snaps
4. All wizards shoot one spell in the direction they are facing
5. Bezoars are collected
6. Ingredients are collected

The spell cast by the wizard will inflict 1 damage token on all wizards that are standing in the direction of the spell.

As indicated the ingredients are collected last in every subround. If a wizard is standing on top of the next ingredient on their list the ingredient is added to their bag and their spawning place is updated to the square they are currently standing on.

At the start of a new round a wizard may choose to brew a healing potion instead of playing. This means that the wizard will not be moving that round but that all damages are removed (and 1 life token is restored?).

Level Design Ideas:
In each game the players seek 2-4 ingredients, depending on the difficulty level. When one ingredient has been collected the spawning place for this wizard moves here.

The Story & World (Narrative):

Story Overview:
Each wizard is given the recipe for a potion, and they compete to finish the potion first. The first to finish the potion wins.

The Game World:
Fantasy and wizarding world inspired.
Lots of different boards could be implemented but the standard board will be placed in a magical forest. Here we will find mysterious creatures and plants.

The Look & Feel (Art & Aesthetics):

Visual Style:
The game should have a warm fantasy aesthetic with a magical feeling. Reference images could be:









Character Appearance:
We must remember that the game will be mostly 2 dimensional, seeing the board from the top and moving around. You should be able to see which direction the wizard is pointing in but otherwise the wizards could just be seen as a hat and wand.
Therefore, we will make the characters very simple. You can choose between a witch or wizard and thereafter 4 different colors to distinguish the players easily.







Menus & Interface (UI/UX):
There will be 3 general menus.

1. Choose your map and potion (Difficulty and estimated time shown for each)
   In the first version there will only be one map and potion.
2. Choose your character
3. The actual gameplay
   The board will be shown from above and your cards will be in the bottom below the board.

The Plan

Rough Timeline: Big goals or phases for development
I only have 1 month so everything must be developed as fast as possible.

Future adding:
Books where you can get new spells.

Bør afklares før eller under implementeringen

- [ ] Kan spells ramme gennem vægge, planter og andre troldmænd?
- [ ] Hvad sker der, hvis flere spillere skubber hinanden i en kæde?
- [ ] Kan en spiller respawne på et felt, hvor en anden spiller står?
- [ ] Udføres alle 4 subrounds, hvis en spiller mister et liv midt i runden?
- [ ] Kan en spiller dø flere gange i samme subround?
- [ ] Skal healing også give 1 life token tilbage, eller kun fjerne damage?
- [ ] Hvordan vinder man præcist ved gryden – kræver brygningen en hel runde?

Kan sagtens vente til senere

- [ ] Hvordan påvirker damage de kort, man får?
- [ ] Hvordan fordeles de 8 kort – er alle kort lige sandsynlige?
- [ ] Respawner bezoars efter indsamling?
- [ ] Hvordan implementeres singleplayer?
- [ ] Hvilke ekstra spells kan tilføjes?
- [ ] Skal forskellige baner have forskellige mekanikker?